

Outlook

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Decline reason versus customer outcome

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The same decline code can lead to a successful retry, an ATM attempt, a phone call or lost activity. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. The first extracts did not reconcile, which means source precedence and exclusions must be part of the answer.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if poor explanations drive complaints more than the decline itself?
2. What evidence would instead support that repeat declines cluster by card state or channel?
3. How do we rule out that most declines recover immediately?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use July 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards which decline reasons need rule, message or service changes. A useful output would be a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: The data does not contain merchant terminal logs or card-scheme dispute outcomes.

Regards